

# João Duarte (JD)

Hi! I'm JD, a UX & Product Design Leader with 20+ years of experience bridging engineering and design to create seamless, data-driven user experiences across web, mobile, and interactive platforms. I take a user-first approach — with over 300+ hours of user interviews and testing, me and my team solve real user needs. I thrive in small, collaborative teams where I can shape ideas from concept to prototype, and bring clarity to complex problems.

## SKILLS

**UX/UI Design**, Wireframing, Prototyping, User Research, Interaction Design, Motion Design, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Journey Mapping, Behavioral Design, Design Thinking, Heatmaps & Click Tracking

## EXPERIENCE

### **BodyVerse** : Head of Product Design | APR 2024 - PRESENT

Built and currently leading the in-house art team, including animators and a UI designer, with ongoing growth to include 3D and concept artists.

Managing the creation of assets used across the game and social media platforms (Instagram, TikTok), while elevating visual quality through continuous feedback.

Led early-stage user research by interviewing dancers to explore how performance attributes influence movement, helping shape our animation and character design.

Developing Unity-based dance game prototypes, including a server-driven system for degrading animations based on character stats, forming the foundation for a future AI-driven adaptive animation system.

### **Experience LABS** : Product Designer & Engineer (Founder) | JAN 2023 - APR 2024

Founded and led the development of a factory-first e-commerce platform, inspired by experience at MADE.COM.

Created a modular design system to support full brand customisation across storefronts. Designed and implemented key features including checkout, PDP, POS, and account tools.

Built the platform using React.js, Next.js, SCSS, and Medusa.js; integrated Stripe and PayFast payment systems. Conducted user research and A/B testing to validate decisions and improve UX.

### **MADE.com LABS** : Head of Product Design | JAN 2019 - NOV 2022

Co-founded MADE Labs, an innovation team backed by the CTO, to explore emerging tech (AI, AR, VR, 3D workflows) in commerce.

Designed and built showroom apps and interactive tools including real-time moodboards and visual recognition interfaces.

Delivered AI-driven solutions to improve personalisation, recommendations, and product discoverability. Bridged product, design, and engineering through hands-on prototyping and cross-functional collaboration.

## CONTACTS

- [metaphyser@gmail.com](mailto:metaphyser@gmail.com)
- [Linked in](#)
- [GitHub](#)
- [Design Methodology](#)

## TOOLS & CODE

- Figma, Unity, Blender, 3ds Max, Adobe Creative Suite
- TypeScript, Javascript, React JS, Next JS, Three JS, Medusa JS, GraphQL, RESTful, Node JS, SCSS, HTML, AWS, C#, Python

- [Company Linked in](#)

- [Ecommerce Website](#)
- [Company Website](#)
- [Company Linked in](#)

- [Case study: Showroom Screens](#)
- [Case study: 3D Viewer \(AR\)](#)

## EXPERIENCE (2019 - 2002)

### **MADE.com : Head of UX** | JAN 2018 - JAN 2019

Established and grew the UX team, hiring and mentoring 3 designers and 1 researcher to support product and research initiatives.

Integrated user research, usability testing, and data-driven decisions into the design process.

Redesigned MADE.COM's end-to-end purchase experience across mobile and web, including checkout, PDPs, and listing pages, in close collaboration with product, engineering, and research teams.

### **Product ML : Head of Product Design** | MAY 2017 - JAN 2018

Designed brand identity, creative direction, and platform UX. Conducted user research to validate features and guide product scope.

- [Case Study: ML Dashboard](#)

Built and tested product prototypes using Framer, JavaScript, Unity, and C#.

### **Plumbee > GSN : Lead Product Designer** | AUG 2014 - MAY 2017

Designed and animated UI for Mirrorball Slots, Kingdom of Riches, and other social casino games on Facebook and mobile platforms.

- [Plumbee/GSN work](#)

Redesigned the GSN Casino app post-acquisition and coordinated cross-team collaboration between London and San Francisco to ensure creative consistency.

Prototyped gameplay mechanics in Unity and C# to test new interaction ideas and motion systems.

### **TAP Portugal : Principal Product Designer** | APR 2014 - AUG 2014

Designed and implemented an interactive, video-based training course for pilots.

- [E-learning app guide](#)

Created a native mobile app focused on managing aircraft cargo logistics.

Supported improvements to the web purchase flow and developed an internal tool for uniform management.

### **Accedo Agency : Product Designer & Engineer** | JAN 2010 - JAN 2014

Designed and developed digital campaigns and interactive apps for clients including Coca-Cola, Seat, Sumol, and Vodafone.

- [Agency Showreel 2011](#)

Transitioned from UX designer and motion artist into engineering, working across Flex, Flash, and web technologies.

Built museum installations in Brazil and an internal training system for Vodafone.

Led implementation of the agency's interactive website, blending animation with usability and performance.

### **Junior to Senior Product Designer & Engineer** | JAN 2002 - JAN 2009

I started my career at SIC, a major TV channel in Portugal, as a Junior Product Designer, creating websites and interactive apps. Later, I founded Interferência, where I designed and developed digital products. I also helped launch Toxik Creative School and worked at the agency Bloom Graphics.